

Tolga Çakan

Industrial Engineer · Product Manager · Blockchain Researcher

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PROFILE

Industrial engineer and product manager who specifies a product and then builds it. Experience spans product management at a cryptocurrency exchange, Kaizen process improvement on a Toyota assembly line, digital marketing at an agency, and an AI engineering programme. Co-founder of TAB Marketing, delivering NFC, QR and web products to 15+ businesses – owning research and benchmarking, requirements, build, production and launch.

EXPERIENCE

2021 – present	Co-founder & Product Lead, TAB Marketing Physical-digital products for cafés, restaurants and hotels: NFC Google review cards, QR menus, hotel key cards, feedback systems and the websites behind them. Own the brief, product design, supplier and print production, and rollout. Seven product lines, 15+ businesses.
Mar – Jul 2025	Intern, De Marke Agency Digital marketing, and on-site organisation at international tournaments.
Jan – Feb 2025	Product Intern, BTCTurk Technology Product management practice at Turkey's largest cryptocurrency exchange: competitor benchmarking, market research and user testing, plus the internal dashboards and reporting the product team used daily.
Jun – Jul 2024	Engineering Intern, Toyota Motor Manufacturing Turkey Assembly line logistics and Kaizen continuous-improvement projects. On-site, Sakarya.
2022 – 2024	Vice President & Operations Lead, Atatürkçü Düşünce Kulübü, Bilgi University Ran the club's largest events end to end – forums, panels and conferences – owning programme and speaker line-up, sponsorship and budget, venue logistics, and the team working the floor on the day.
2021 – 2024	Editorial Director, Bilgi Blockchain Club Commissioned and edited the club's publications; helped programme its forums and speaker evenings.

SKILLS

Product	Product management · benchmarking · market and competitor research · user testing · requirements and scoping · roadmapping · dashboards and reporting · stakeholder communication
Engineering	Python · SQL · JavaScript · TypeScript · React · Next.js · Vite · HTML · CSS · Git · Vercel
Analysis	Excel · VBA · data analysis · process improvement (Kaizen) · production and vendor logistics · supply chain
Design	Figma · UI/UX collaboration · print and packaging production
AI	LLM-assisted workflows · prompt design and iteration · Anthropic tooling · AI product research
Blockchain	Protocol and token economics · exchange and DeFi mechanics · wallets and on-chain fundamentals · published sector research
Events & ops	Large-scale forums and conferences · programme and speaker planning · sponsorship · budget · venue logistics · team leadership on the day
Physical × digital	NFC systems · QR routing · retail and hospitality deployment
Languages	Turkish (native) · English (professional working proficiency)

EDUCATION

- Istanbul Bilgi University – BSc Industrial Engineering
- Fen Lisesi – Sakarya, Turkey

PUBLICATION

- Chapter on blockchain and the entertainment industry in *Blockchain Teknolojileri ve Sektörel Etkileri*. Nobel Bilimsel Eserler, 2022. Published as Mehmet Tolga Çakan. ISBN 978-625-433-825-0

PROGRAMMES & CERTIFICATES

- AI Engineering Internship, FlyRank AI (2026) – remote, project-based: five reviewed assignments and a capstone, built around shipping real work
- AI Fluency: Framework & Foundations, Anthropic (2026)
- Claude 101, Anthropic (2026)
- Award, ÖRS Textile senior design project, CSRP (2026)

INTERNATIONAL & INVOLVEMENT

- Volunteer researcher, He For She / Erasmus+ – Saaremaa, Estonia (2023–2024). Field research on gender equality with an international team, written up for the programme
- European Summer School, Blockchain to Financial Markets – Prague, Czechia (2025). Settlement, tokenised assets and the regulation around them